

# MIRACLE ON DICE

THE HOCKEY DICE GAME

## RULEBOOK

v3.4

© 2026 Tim Wherry. For personal use only.

# 1 GAME OVERVIEW & COMPONENTS

Miracle on Dice is a two-player hockey-themed dice-building game. Each player assembles a roster of player cards, builds a bag of dice representing their team, and battles through three periods of strategic rolling, zone management, and shot-on-goal combat. The team with the most goals after three periods wins.

The game comes from the bag-building dice tradition of games like Dice Masters, with hockey pacing layered in: a period clock, Cold and Hot offensive zones, defensive block bonuses, costed power faces, and an economy that grows period to period.

## Components

- **Player cards** — 7 per player: 3 Forwards, 2 Defensemen, 1 Goalie, 1 Head Coach.
- **Dice** — Forward cards hold 4 dice, Defenseman cards hold 3, Goalie cards hold 2 — all available for purchase during play. The Head Coach die rolls automatically each turn and is never purchased. The starting bag is 19 Rookie dice plus 1 Goon die.
- **Combat dice** — Shoot dice (blue) and Block dice (red). Shoot dice: 3, 2, 1, 0, 0, 0. Block dice: 3, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0. Fight dice: 2, 2, 1, 1, 0, 0.
- **Tokens** — Shoot tokens (blue) and Block tokens (red). Each committed token adds an automatic +1 to your combat total.
- **Penalty dice** — all-blank dice used for bag disruption. 3 in the shared pool.
- **Playmat** (one per player) — Roll & Sort Zone, Offensive Cold Zone, Offensive Hot Zone, Shoot Zone, Defensive Zone, Block Zone, Bench (max 2), Reserve (max 2), Iced Zone, Period Timer, Goals tracker, Period marker.
- **Period Timer card** — a shared countdown clock. Each period runs 10:00 — five turns per player, echoing hockey shifts across a period.

## Starting bag

Both players begin every period with the same starting bag of **19 Rookie dice and 1 Goon die**. Your bag grows in power as you purchase position dice during play. Forwards and Defensemen are available at Tiers 1–5; Goalies at Tiers 3–5.

## The playtesting app

An official simulator implements every rule in this book and is free to use. Play solo against yourself, take on AI Chuck (the built-in AI opponent), or play online: one player hosts a room and shares the 6-character room code, and the other joins from any browser. The app enforces turn order, the period clock, combat math, and all phase rules automatically — it is the fastest way to learn the game and to try out new lineups before committing them to a physical build.

The simulator also runs as an installable phone app: open the URL on your phone and choose “Add to Home screen.” Phone and desktop share the same online rooms, so a phone can play against a computer with the same room code.

https://zappbrannigan79.github.io/Miracle_On_Dice/

## 2 TEAM BUILDING & LINEUP

Before the game begins, each player picks one of the **20 prebuilt teams**. Every team is built to exactly **20 points** — there is no team builder and no custom lineups. The Head Coach card is your 7th slot: mandatory and automatic, costing no points.

### Lineup composition

- Exactly **3 Forward** cards (F1–F5)
- Exactly **2 Defenseman** cards (D1–D5)
- Exactly **1 Goalie** card (G3–G5)
- No duplicate tiers per position — no team carries two F5s or two D3s.

### Point budget

Each position card costs points equal to its tier number: an F5 costs 5 points, a D4 costs 4, a G3 costs 3. All 20 teams total **exactly 20 points** — for example, F4+F2+F1+D5+D4+G4 = 4+2+1+5+4+4 = 20. Teams are organized across four divisions — North, East, South, and West — each with its own playstyle identity, from offense-heavy to defense-first.

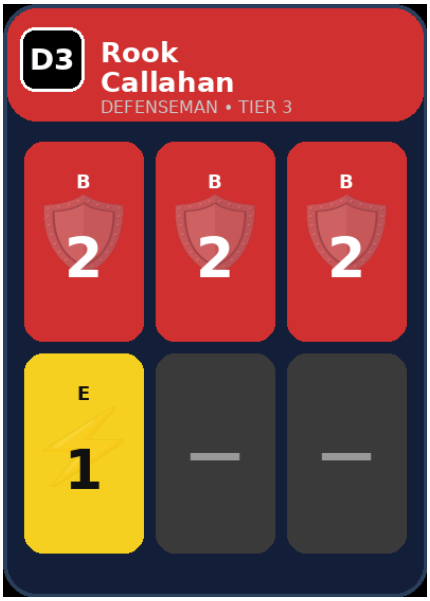
## 3 DICE FACES

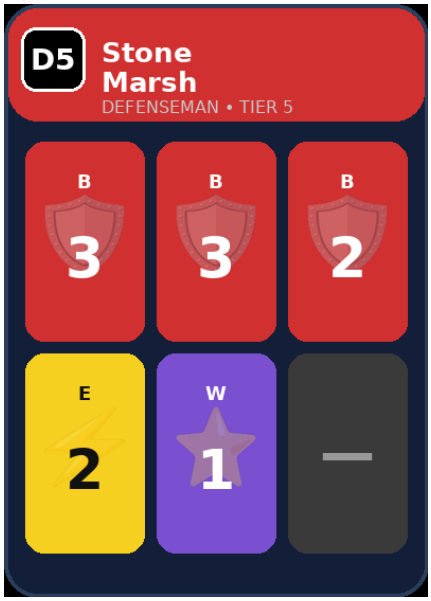
All player dice are six-sided. Pip values increase with tier. Some faces carry a cost — these require **1 Energy pip** to advance from the Roll & Sort Zone, and are marked with ⚡.

Every face as it appears in the app — the faded symbol behind the pip, big number, small letter:

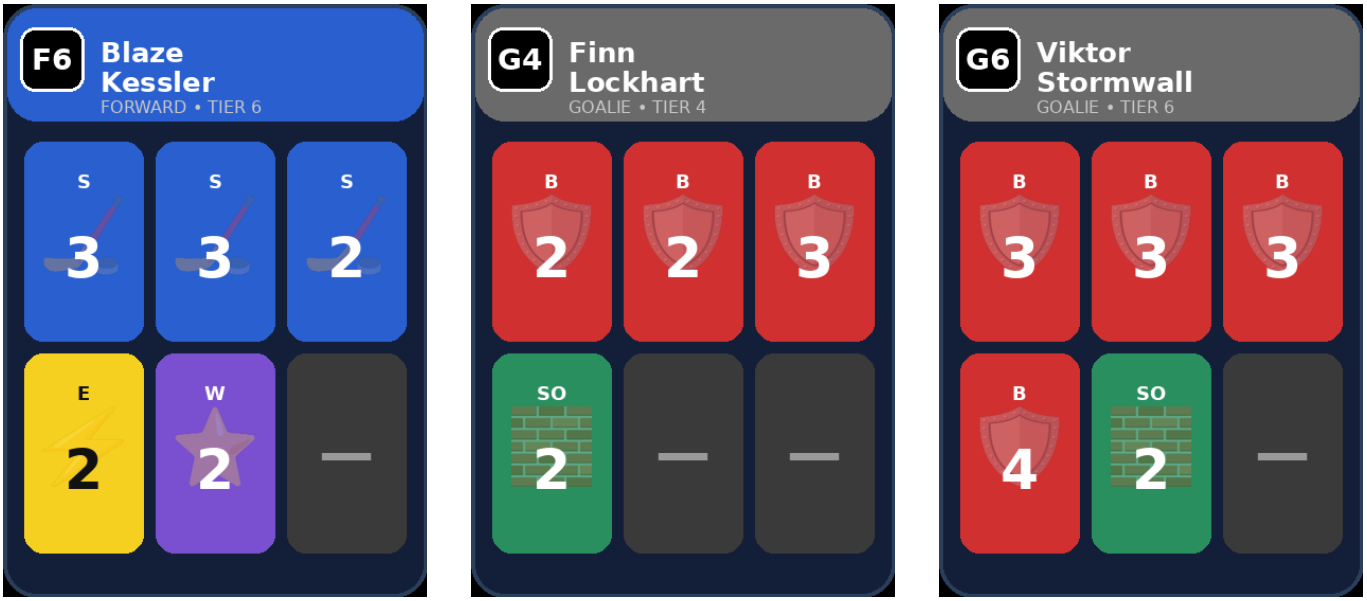



Shoot • Block • Energy • Wild • Blank • Shutout • Reroll • Advance • Fight






## Player card examples

Each player card shows the position, tier, and all six die faces. Blue = Forward, Red = Defenseman, Gray = Goalie:

## Face symbol key

- **E (1/2/3)** — Energy. Stays in the Roll & Sort Zone as purchasing power. Up to 2 Energy-face dice may be kept in Reserve (never the HC die).
- **S** — Shoot (free). Advance to the Offensive Zone. Pip value = combat dice when shooting.
- **S ⚡** — Shoot (costed). Pay 1 Energy pip, then advance.
- **B** — Block (free). Advance to the Defensive Zone. Pip value = combat dice when blocking.
- **B ⚡** — Block (costed). Pay 1 Energy pip, then advance.
- **W** — Wild. Declare as Shoot or Block for the turn and advance to the matching zone. No cost, and Wild dice can never sit in Reserve.
- **RR** — Reroll. Spend to reroll any remaining unassigned Roll & Sort dice, even after other dice have been assigned; the die then moves to the Iced Zone.
- **SO ⚡** — Shutout (Goalie only). Spend 1 Energy, gain the printed Block Tokens, move the die to the Iced Zone.
- **RR** — Reroll (HC only, two faces). Spend to reroll any dice in Roll & Sort.
- **ADV** — Advance (HC only). Immediately move any one die from the Cold Zone to the Hot Zone. That die is now eligible to commit to a shot this turn.
- **FT** — Fight (Goon only). May start a fight — see “The Goon” below.

> **SHUTOUT.** If you cannot pay the 1 Energy for a Shutout face, leave the Goalie die unresolved — it falls to the Iced Zone at end of turn, but no tokens are gained.

## Forward dice (F1–F6)

3 Energy faces • 1 free Shoot • 1 costed Shoot • 1 Wild

| Tier | 1E | 2E | 3E | S (free) | S (cost) | Wild |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| F1 | E1 | E2 | E2 | S1 | S1 ⚡ | W1 |
| F2 | E1 | E2 | E2 | S1 | S2 ⚡ | W1 |
| F3 | E1 | E2 | E2 | S2 | S2 ⚡ | W1 |
| F4 | E1 | E2 | E3 | S2 | S2 ⚡ | W2 |
| F5 | E1 | E2 | E3 | S2 | S3 ⚡ | W2 |
| F6 | E1 | E2 | E3 | S3 | S3 ⚡ | W2 |

## Defenseman dice (D1–D6)

3 Energy faces • 1 free Block • 1 costed Block • 1 Wild

| Tier | 1E | 2E | 3E | B (free) | B (cost) | Wild |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| D1 | E1 | E2 | E2 | B1 | B1 ⚡ | W1 |
| D2 | E1 | E2 | E2 | B1 | B2 ⚡ | W1 |
| D3 | E1 | E2 | E2 | B2 | B2 ⚡ | W1 |
| D4 | E1 | E2 | E3 | B2 | B2 ⚡ | W2 |
| D5 | E1 | E2 | E3 | B2 | B3 ⚡ | W2 |
| D6 | E1 | E2 | E3 | B3 | B3 ⚡ | W2 |

## Goalie dice (G3–G6)

5 Block faces (one costed) • 1 costed Shutout — no Energy, Wild, or Blank faces

| Tier | B | B | B | B | B (cost) | SO (cost) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| G3 | B2 | B2 | B2 | B3 | B3 ⚡ | 2 tokens ⚡ |
| G4 | B2 | B2 | B3 | B3 | B3 ⚡ | 2 tokens ⚡ |
| G5 | B2 | B3 | B3 | B3 | B4 ⚡ | 2 tokens ⚡ |
| G6 | B3 | B3 | B3 | B4 | B4 ⚡ | 2 tokens ⚡ |

## Rookie & Head Coach dice

| Die | Face 1 | Face 2 | Face 3 | Face 4 | Face 5 | Face 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rookie | E1 | E2 | S1 | B1 | BLANK | BLANK |
| Head Coach | E1 | E1 | E2 | RR | RR | ADV |
| Goon | E1 | E1 | E2 | FT | FT | FT |

## Wild results

A Wild face may be declared as either of the following. Your choice is binding for the turn:

- **Shoot** — place in the Offensive Zone (Cold or Hot per the clock). Uses the Wild pip value in combat.
- **Block** — place in the Defensive Zone. Uses the Wild pip value in combat.

### The Goon

One green Goon die replaces a Rookie in your starting bag. Its Energy faces work like any Energy die (and may sit in Reserve). Its FT faces may start a fight:

- On your turn, an FT face in the Roll & Sort Zone may challenge one opponent die in their Cold, Defensive, or Hot Zone. (Once per turn; you may decline.)
- Both sides roll fight combat dice (2, 2, 1, 1, 0, 0): the Goon rolls 3, the target rolls 2. Ties go to the target.
- **Goon wins:** the target is iced. **Goon loses:** the target stays, and a Penalty die goes into your bag. The Goon ices either way.

## 4 THE HEAD COACH CARD & DIE

Each player brings one Head Coach card as their 7th lineup slot. Unlike position cards, the HC die is never purchased and never enters the bag. It is set aside at the start of the game and automatically added to every roll each turn — alongside the 6 drawn dice and any Bench dice.

After any HC die face resolves, the die returns to its set-aside position. It does not enter the Iced Zone, the bag, the Bench, or the Reserve. The HC die exists in only two states: rolling in the Roll & Sort Zone during your active turn, or set aside waiting for the next turn.

### HC die faces

- **E1, E2** — Energy faces. These pips are available for purchasing or cost payment this turn. The HC die is never saved to Reserve.
- **RR, RR** — Reroll faces. Spend to reroll any remaining unassigned Roll & Sort dice, even after other dice have been assigned, then the HC die returns to set-aside.
- **ADV** — Advance. Immediately move any one die from the Offensive Cold Zone to the Hot Zone. That die is now eligible to commit to a shot this turn.
- **PEN** — Penalty (via Goon fight). Add 1 Penalty die from the shared pool to the opponent's bag. If the pool is empty, no Penalty die is added.

> **KEY RULE.** The ADV face MAY NOT be resolved during the first turn of each period (the 10:00 turn), since the opposing player has not yet had a turn to put in any defense.

## 5 PERIOD STRUCTURE & FACEOFF

A full game consists of **three periods** sharing one countdown clock. The clock ticks down 1 minute per turn, alternating between players. At the start of each period, both players **simultaneously roll 2 Shoot combat dice**. Higher total wins — ties reroll. The faceoff winner **takes the odd-numbered clock turns** for the period (9:00, 7:00, 5:00, 3:00, and the final 1:00 turn) and **gains 1 token of their choice — Shoot or Block**. The other player takes the even-numbered turns (10:00, 8:00, 6:00, 4:00, 2:00) and shoots first. The period ends after the 1:00 turn is completed.

> **PHYSICAL TIMER TIP.** The Period Timer card can be rotated 180° each period so the faceoff winner always reads their turns from the nearest end of the card.

### Period reset

When the clock reaches 00:00, all dice on both playmats return to their owner's bag — Offensive Zone, Defensive Zone, Bench, and Iced Zone all reset. **Reserve dice may persist**: players may keep any dice in their Reserve for the next period. **Tokens persist**: Shoot and Block tokens carry over between periods. The Period marker advances and a new faceoff begins.

## 6 TURN STRUCTURE

Each turn flows through five steps in order.

### Step 1 — Advance

Move all dice from the Offensive Cold Zone into the Hot Zone. These dice are now eligible for a shot this turn.

### Step 2 — Draw

Draw 6 dice blindly from your bag. Add any dice on the Bench (maximum 2). Your total roll pool is 6–8 dice plus the automatic HC die.

> **PENALTY DICE.** If a Penalty die is drawn, it counts toward your 6-die draw. After rolling (it shows blank), the Penalty die is immediately returned to the shared pool — it does not sit in your Iced Zone or stay in your bag. The shared pool holds 3 Penalty dice; when a Penalty die would be added but the pool is empty, nothing happens. The disruption is temporary: one wasted draw slot per cycle through the bag.

### Step 3 — Roll & Assign

Roll all drawn dice plus the HC die into the Roll & Sort Zone. You may then select any number of Roll & Sort dice and reroll them once, for free. This free reroll must happen **before any die is assigned**. An RR face may also be spent to reroll remaining unassigned dice — even after you have started assigning other dice. A die spun down to pay energy (e.g. 2⚡ → 1⚡) is spent and **cannot be rerolled** this turn.

Assign each Roll & Sort die one at a time, in any order:

- **S** — advance to the Cold Zone (clock 10:00–05:00) or Hot Zone (clock 04:00–00:00).
- **S** ⚡ — pay 1 Energy pip, then advance to the appropriate Offensive Zone.
- **B** — advance to the Defensive Zone.
- **B** ⚡ — pay 1 Energy pip, then advance to the Defensive Zone.
- **W** — declare as Shoot or Block; advance to the appropriate zone. No cost.
- **E** — stays in the Roll & Sort Zone as purchasing power. One non-HC E-face die may optionally move to an open Reserve slot.

- **RR** — reroll remaining unassigned Roll & Sort dice (may be spent even after other dice have been assigned); the HC die returns to set-aside, a normal die moves to Iced.
- **SO** ⚡ — pay 1 Energy pip, gain the printed Block Tokens, move the Goalie die to the Iced Zone.
- **ADV (HC)** — immediately advance one Cold Zone die to the Hot Zone.
- **BLANK / Penalty die** — no effect. Falls to the Iced Zone at end of turn.

**Buying is not a separate step.** Spend Energy pips from Roll & Sort dice (and the Reserve, if available) to purchase dice or tokens **at any point during your turn** when you have Energy available — before, during, or after assigning. You may only purchase dice from your own 6 lineup cards (Forwards hold 4 dice, Defensemen 3, Goalies 2). **Every purchase trashes one Rookie:** trash a Rookie from your iced dice, or ice one from your zones/reserve to trash. You cannot buy without fodder.

| Purchase type | Cost | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Position die | Tier number in Energy | F5 = 5E, D4 = 4E, G3 = 3E. Trash 1 iced Rookie |
| Token | 3E per token | Max 1 Shoot + 1 Block bought per turn |
| Sell-out bonus | Free | +1 token on a card's last die (exempt from cap) |
| Goalie buy bonus | Free | +1 Block token when buying any goalie die |

- **Sell-out bonus** — when you purchase the final die from any lineup card (4th forward, 3rd defenseman, 2nd goalie), gain 1 token immediately: a Shoot token for forwards, a Block token for defensemen. Sell-out tokens ignore the per-turn token cap.
- **Goalie buy bonus** — when you purchase any goalie die, gain 1 Block token immediately.
- **Purchased dice** go directly to your Iced Zone and enter your bag at the next shuffle or period reset.

## Economy notes

- Energy faces cap at 3E per face — efficiency beats raw accumulation.
- **Spin-down:** if spending part of an Energy die's value, the remaining pips stay on that die in the Roll & Sort Zone for further use.
- Costed faces compete directly with buying — every pip spent advancing a costed face is one less pip toward a purchase.
- **Every buy trashes a Rookie** — bag-thinning is built into upgrading. Buy early and often.
- The **Reserve** (max 2 Energy dice, never the HC die) is your cross-turn savings account for big purchases.

## The Reserve

The Reserve holds up to 2 dice showing Energy faces (1E, 2E, or 3E). The HC die may not be placed in Reserve. There is no pip maximum — the limit is by dice count only. Reserved dice persist between turns: at the start of your next turn, you may spend them to buy a die or as a cost payment. At the end of your turn, if a Reserve slot is open and you have unspent Energy dice in the Roll & Sort Zone, the leftover dice are automatically saved to the empty slots, biggest first.

## Step 4 — Shoot

You may declare **at most one shot per turn**. Move any dice from the Hot Zone into the Shoot Zone and resolve combat (see Section 8).

### Step 5 — End turn

Tick the Period Timer down 1 minute. All remaining unassigned Roll & Sort dice fall to the Iced Zone. The HC die returns to its set-aside position. If the clock reaches 00:00 after the 1:00 turn, the period ends.

## 7 PERIOD TIMER & ZONE PACING

| Clock | Offensive placement | Defender bonus |
|---|---|---|
| 10:00 – 05:00 | Cold Zone (heats to Hot next turn) | +1 automatic Block die |
| 04:00 – 02:00 | Hot Zone (same-turn shot possible) | +2 automatic Block dice |
| 01:00 (final turn) | Hot Zone | +3 automatic Block dice |
| 00:00 | Period ends | All dice return to bags |

> **COLD ZONE CYCLE.** A die in the Cold Zone cannot be used for a shot until the following turn, when it advances to the Hot Zone during Step 1. Planning a shot in the 10:00–05:00 window requires two turns of setup. The ADV face on the HC die can short-circuit this — advancing a Cold Zone die immediately to Hot.

## 8 SHOT ON GOAL & COMBAT RESOLUTION

A shot on goal may be declared at most once per turn. Only dice in the Hot Zone may be committed to a shot.

### Step 1 — Declare the attack

Move any number of dice from the Hot Zone into the Shoot Zone. Optionally commit Shoot tokens (each = +1 to your final combat total, not an extra die). At least one die must be committed to attempt a shot.

### Step 2 — Defensive reaction

The defending player moves any dice from the Defensive Zone into the Block Zone, and may commit Block tokens. The defender also receives automatic bonus Block dice from the period clock: **+1** from 10:00–05:00, **+2** from 04:00–02:00, **+3** on the 1:00 turn.

### Step 3 — Combat roll

- Attacker rolls Shoot combat dice equal to the **total pip value** of all committed Shoot Zone dice.
- Defender rolls Block combat dice equal to the total pip value of all committed Block Zone dice, **plus the automatic clock bonus**.
- Shoot dice faces: 3, 2, 1, 0, 0, 0. Block dice faces: 3, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0. Sum all results.
- Add committed tokens as flat +1 additions to each side's total.

### Step 4 — Result

- **GOAL:** attacker's total strictly greater than defender's total.

- **BLOCKED:** defender's total equal to or greater than attacker's total. Ties always go to defense.

### Step 5 — Post-combat die movement

- **GOAL** — attacking dice → attacker's Iced Zone. Blocking dice → defender's Bench.
- **BLOCKED** — attacking dice → attacker's Bench. Blocking dice → defender's Iced Zone.
- If more than 2 dice would go to a Bench at once, the owner **chooses 2** — the rest go to the Iced Zone.

> **CATCH-UP MECHANIC.** Both outcomes keep both players in the game. Scoring sends your opponent's blockers to their Bench for a larger draw. Getting blocked sends your attackers to your Bench for a larger draw next turn.

## 9 THE BENCH & ICED ZONE

The **Bench** holds a maximum of 2 dice. Bench dice are added directly to your draw pool at the start of your next Draw step, without counting toward your 6-die draw. If more than 2 dice would go to the Bench at once, choose 2 — the rest go to the Iced Zone. **No benching on your last turn of a period**: after the 01:00 turn (or the 02:00 turn for the player who shot it), dice go straight to the Iced Zone — there is no next draw before the period reset.

The **Iced Zone** is your waiting area — think of it as your discard pile. When your bag empties during a Draw step, all Iced Zone dice shuffle together to refill it. Purchased dice enter the Iced Zone immediately and join your bag at the next shuffle or period reset.

## 10 WINNING THE GAME

### Three-period game

The player with the most goals after three complete periods wins. If tied, proceed to the shootout.

### Shootout

- Each player empties their bag, sets aside **one Goalie die** to defend with (if you own no Goalie die, use a G3), and places **one die per position card** — one per forward, one per defenseman — into the empty bag. Each player randomly draws 3 dice from their bag to act as their shooters.
- The first shooter is **randomly selected** (in the digital app, a coin flip decides it).
- Players arrange their 3 shooters in an order they choose. Each round, both players take one shot with their next shooter — three rounds total.
- The shooter rolls their die once (no reroll); the goalie rolls their Goalie die once (no reroll). Costed faces are treated as free.
- Every face uses its **pip value only** — face type does not matter. Pips grant that many Shoot combat dice (shooter) or Block combat dice (goalie).
- Both sides roll their combat dice. Shooter's total > goalie's total = **GOAL**. Goalie's total ≥ shooter's total = **SAVED** (ties go to the defender).

- A Blank face = 0 pips = automatic miss. A Shutout face on the goalie counts as defending pips only (no tokens gained).
- Most goals in 3 rounds wins. If still tied, **sudden death** begins: each round, both players draw a single shooter at random from the dice remaining in their bag. When a player's bag is empty, all 5 skaters are returned to the bag and the single draws continue. Play continues one round at a time until one player scores and the other does not in the same round.

# 11 QUICK REFERENCE

### Turn summary

- **Step 1 — Advance:** move all Cold Zone dice to the Hot Zone.
- **Step 2 — Draw:** draw 6 from bag + Bench dice + HC die auto-rolls (6–8 dice + HC).
- **Step 3 — Roll & Assign:** roll all into the Roll & Sort Zone. Optional free reroll before any assignment. Assign: S/B free → zone; S/B cost → pay 1E then zone; W → declare Shoot or Block; E → stays in Roll & Sort (optionally Reserve); RR → reroll remaining dice (even after assigning); ADV → Cold to Hot; BLANK → Iced at end. Buy any time Energy is available: dice (cost = tier), Trade (cost + 2E), tokens (3E).
- **Step 4 — Shoot:** optional, one shot per turn. Commit Hot Zone dice.
- **Step 5 — End turn:** clock down 1. Unassigned dice → Iced. HC → set aside.

### Key rules at a glance

- Starting bag: 19 Rookie dice + 1 Goon die. No position dice until purchased.
- 20 prebuilt teams at exactly 20 points: 3F + 2D + 1G. No team builder.
- No duplicate tiers per position in your lineup.
- Pip value on a die face = number of combat dice that die grants. Higher tier = more combat dice.
- Cost faces (⚡): pay 1 Energy pip to advance. Spin the paying die down by 1 pip.
- Free reroll must happen before any die is assigned this turn.
- Reserve: max 2 Energy-face dice (never the HC die). Persists between turns and periods.
- Bench: max 2 dice. Added to next draw automatically; the shot's loser chooses which dice bench.
- Every buy trashes one Rookie permanently (from iced, or iced from your zones/reserve). No buy without fodder.
- One shot per turn. Ties in combat always go to defense.
- Sell-out (last die on a card): +1 token — Shoot for forwards, Block for defensemen.
- Penalty dice return to the shared pool of 3 immediately after being drawn and rolled.
- HC die never enters the Iced Zone, bag, Bench, or Reserve.

### Glossary

- **Iced Zone:** your discard pile. Refills the bag when it empties. Purchased dice wait here.
- **Bench:** max 2 dice. Auto-added to next draw. Overflow goes to the Iced Zone.
- **Reserve:** max 2 Energy-face dice (never the HC die). Persists between turns and periods.
- **Cold Zone:** offensive staging area. Advances to the Hot Zone at the start of your next turn.

- **Hot Zone:** dice here are eligible to commit to a shot this turn.
- **Buy cost:** Energy equal to the die's tier number, plus trashing one Rookie.
- **Trash on buy:** every purchase permanently removes one Rookie from your Iced Zone.
- **Cost face (⚡):** requires 1 Energy pip to advance. The paying die spins down by 1.
- **Spin-down:** reducing an Energy die's pip value by 1 when paying a cost.
- **Shutout (SO ⚡):** Goalie face; costs 1E; grants Block tokens, then the die goes to Iced.
- **Wild (W):** declare as Shoot or Block. Advances to the appropriate zone. No cost.
- **ADV (HC):** advance one Cold Zone die immediately to the Hot Zone.
- **Penalty die:** all-blank die. Returned to the shared pool immediately after being drawn and rolled.
- **Sell-out:** purchasing a card's last die (4th forward, 3rd defenseman, 2nd goalie). Buyer gains 1 token immediately.
- **Period reset:** all playmat dice (except Reserve) return to owners' bags at period end.
- **Faceoff:** roll 2 combat dice each; winner takes even clock turns and gains 1 Shoot or Block token (their choice).

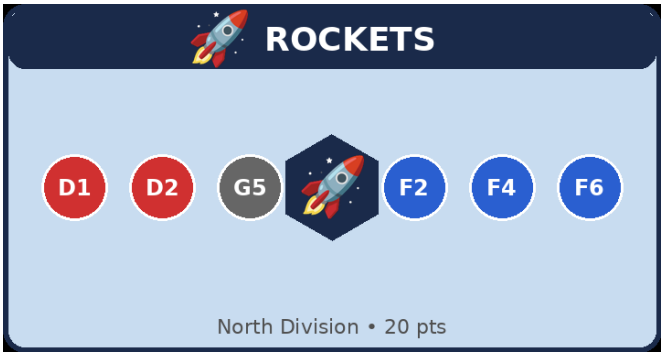
# A APPENDIX — TEAM LINEUP CARDS

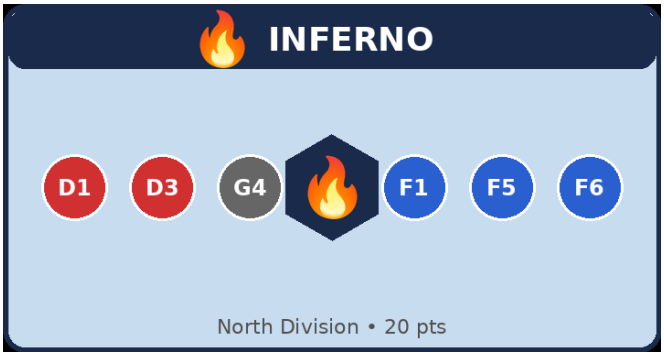
The game ships with **20 prebuilt Team Lineup Cards** — there is no team builder and no custom lineups. Each card shows a complete 20-point roster with a clear playstyle identity. Pick your team and play.

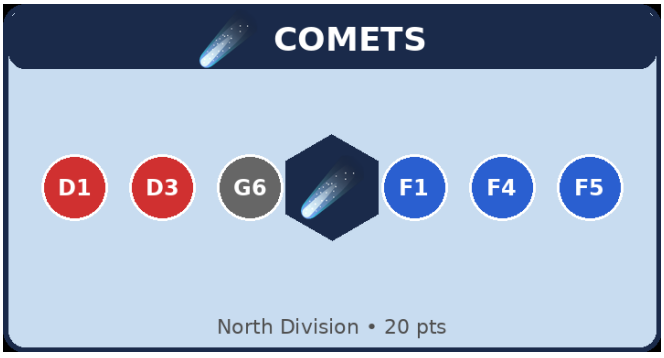
The 20 teams are organized across four divisions — North (offense-heavy), East (offense-leaning), South (defense-leaning), and West (defense-heavy).

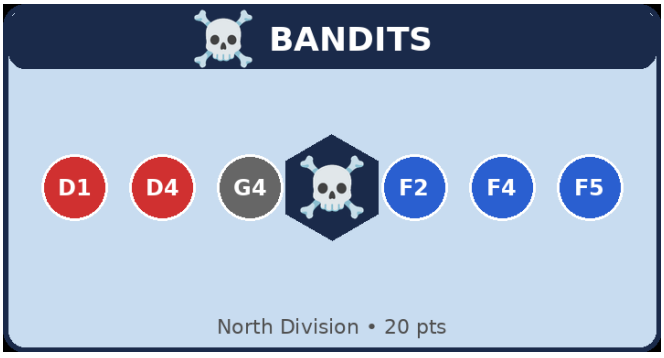
## North Division

Offense-heavy — pick your team and play.



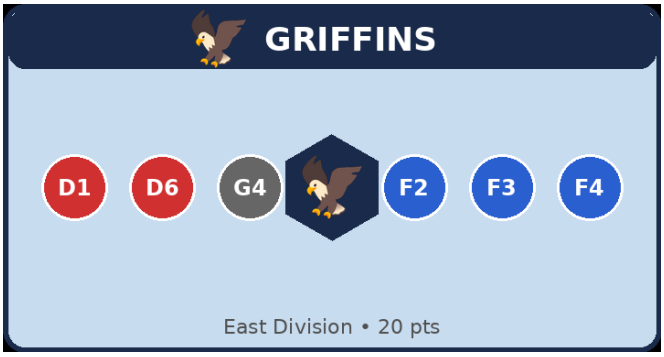



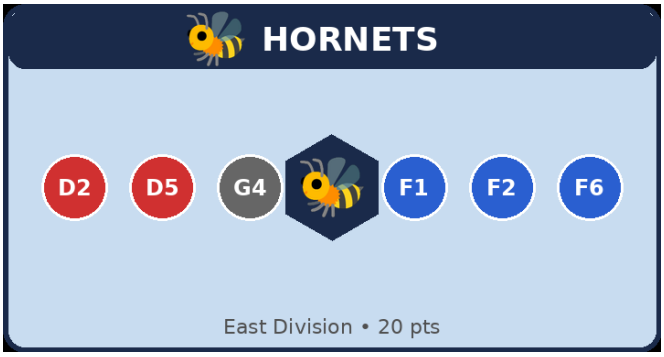



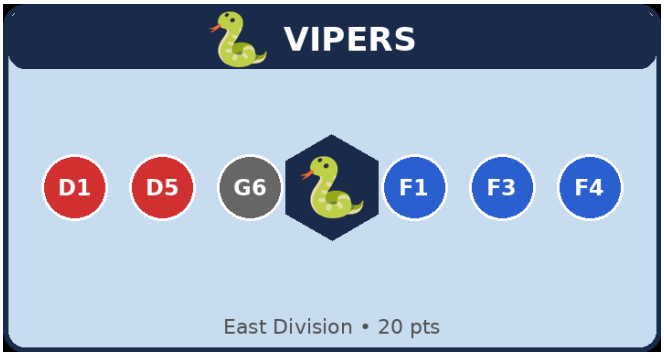


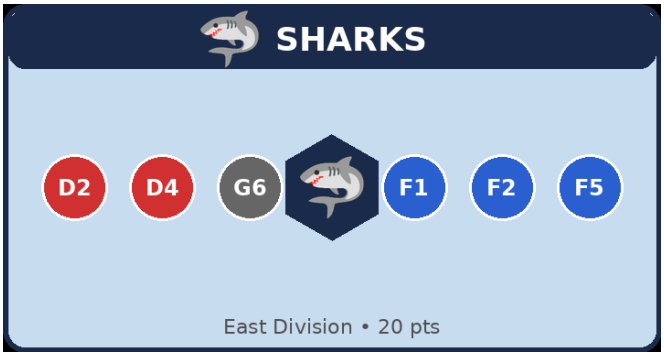

## East Division

Offense-leaning — pick your team and play.



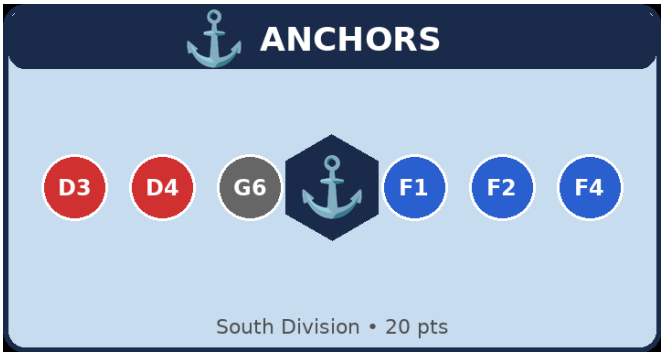



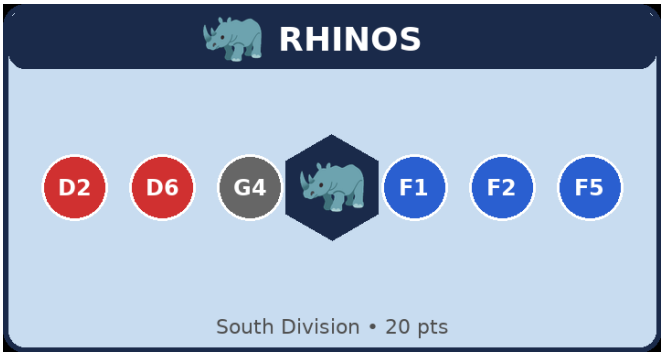






## South Division

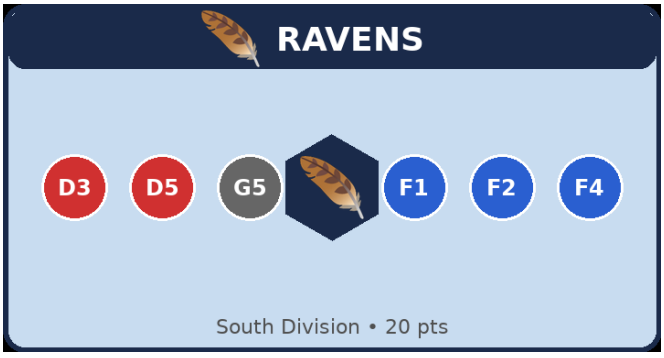
Defense-leaning — pick your team and play.

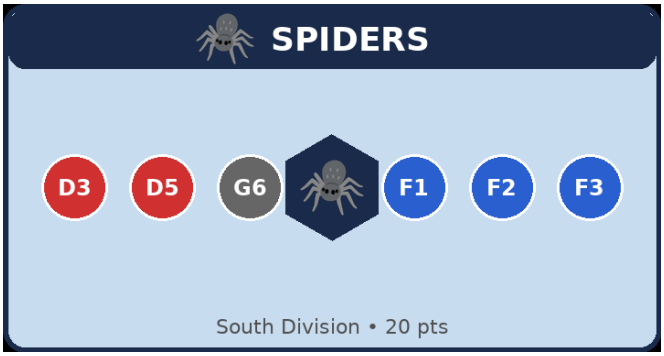








## West Division

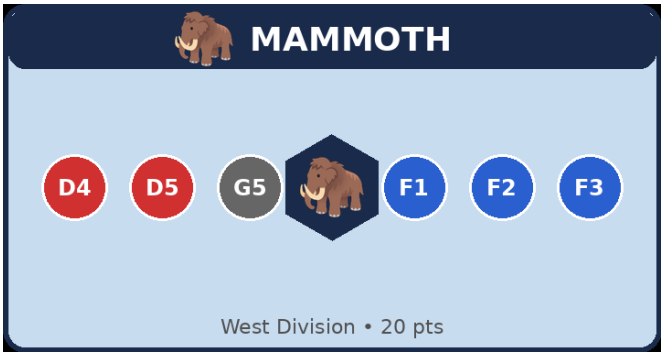
Defense-heavy — pick your team and play.

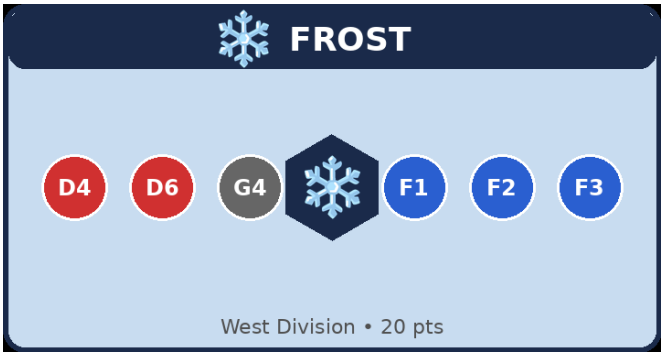











© 2026 Tim Wherry. For personal use only.

MIRACLE ON DICE • Rulebook v3.4